# David Adeshina Arungbemi

*I follow what moves me, then test whether it's true. Also writes as Suzume.*

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Designers steering generative models
- Learning a person's taste from their choices
- Making model behaviour visible
- Gesture and pen interaction
- Generative art

## EDUCATION

**B.Eng. Computer Engineering, Nile University of Nigeria** 2019 – 2024

First Class Honours, CGPA 5.0 / 5.0. Valedictorian and best overall graduate. 90% scholarship. Thesis (group project, three students): a wrist-worn gesture-recognition device using motion sensors. Our approach scored 94.9% on the public 6DMG dataset; retrained on our own device, it reached about 60% with two new users.

## PUBLICATIONS

**Narrative Transportation and Speciesism in Large Language Models** 2026

D. A. Arungbemi. Preprint, not peer-reviewed. Zenodo. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21294610 · PDF

I gave five language models a story about an animal, the same facts written plainly, or an essay arguing for animals. Only the story clearly made their answers more caring toward that animal.

**An End to End Wearable Device and System for Indefinite, Continuous, Real Time Gesture Recognition of Directional and Shape-Based Arm Gestures** 2025

*IEEE Access*, vol. 13, pp. 153436–153463. Peer-reviewed. Co-author.

doi:10.1109/ACCESS.2025.3602871

My part: the AI that recognises the gestures, and the interface of the live app people use with it.

## FELLOWSHIPS & PROGRAMMES

**Research Fellow, MARS 5.0, Cambridge AI Safety Hub** 2026 – now

A mentored AI safety research programme. I test whether training a language model on a story changes the values it acts on, comparing each story with the same text rewritten neutrally or with its ending flipped. I design the experiments and datasets, run the training (supervised fine-tuning, distillation, GRPO) on Gemma and Qwen models, and present results to the cohort. Mentor: Elizaveta Tennant (Google DeepMind / UCL).

- **A story that acts without being named.** Trained on a fable written as its own answers about itself, a small model (Gemma 4) shifted its decisions the way the fable does when it is in the prompt, while a control trained on an unrelated text moved the other way; no reasoning trace named the fable.
- **Describing versus using a reasoning process.** I trained a small model on first-person accounts of how it reasons: by projecting a known story onto a new situation (Mark Turner, *The Literary Mind*). It described the process almost every time it was asked and brought that story into its reasoning on about 70% of 2,000 dilemmas, yet its overall decisions barely changed: whether it learned the process or only its words is still open.

**Research Fellow, Futurekind Fellowship, Electric Sheep** 2026

A 12-week fellowship on AI and animal welfare, where I wrote the preprint above.

**Selected, Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute** 2026

An interdisciplinary programme on how humans, animals and machines think.

**Finalist, MATS**
Passed the coding and writing stages to reach the final round of a selective AI safety research programme, in its AI welfare stream.

## EXPERIENCE

**Co-founder & Lead AI, Gyronics Technologies** Nov 2024 – now
An assistive wearable for accessibility that recognises arm gestures. I designed the device's look in Blender and built its gesture recognition, helped build the tool our team uses to watch participants' gesture data live, and made a view that draws a gesture as the path of a virtual pen.

**Research Intern, National Centre for AI and Robotics, Abuja** Feb 2025 – Jan 2026
A live video system that tracks people and objects and maps how near they are to each other, and a robot arm guided only by a camera.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

**LLM Art Director** 2026
A language model edits photos guided by beauty scores, and a pretrained human-preference model (PickScore) rolls back edits a person would likely not prefer. When that check wasn't working, the scores rose while the photos got worse.

**Aesthetics Optimizer** 2026
Predicting the brain's fMRI response (BOLD5000) to a new image, personalised from a person's ranked image history, with a desktop app that tunes generative art to raise the prediction. The predictions were weak (mean r ≈ 0.08), and the write-up analyses why.

**Wen's Mindscape** 2026
I tested how a small language model behaves across 32 areas, then turned the results into a constellation you can explore.

## SELECTED WRITING

**Sculpting Latent Space: What If AI Could Think in Clay?** 2026
What if people could reshape what a model has learned, one correction at a time, without retraining it?

**Dream a Better Dream** 2026
Understanding what we see before we can explain it, and what people bring to an AI future.

**You Are What You Prefer** 2026
A model's small preferences as a fingerprint of its character, and an alarm when it changes.

17 articles in all at suzume1.medium.com · generative art at davidadeshinaarungbemi.github.io/images.html

## SKILLS

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| Research | Reading papers, designing and running experiments, evaluating results, writing them up and presenting them; fMRI modelling (public BOLD5000 data) |
| Models | Fine-tuning small language models (supervised, GRPO) with PyTorch, Hugging Face and Unsloth on RunPod; benchmarks; LLM-as-judge; multi-agent simulations |
| Building | Python (main) with Claude Code; C++ (ImGui / ImPlot); apps and visualisations in React and Three.js |
| Design | Wearable device design, data visualisation, Blender, creative coding in Processing |